Skewness

Background You are given two datasets

Task 1 Identify the skewness of dataset 1. You may use the formula from the lesson, the skewness formula in excel (=SKEW) or you can plot it on a graph

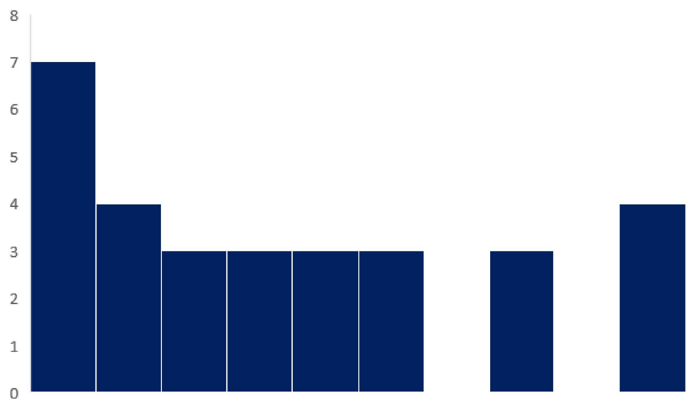
Task 2 Identify the skewness of dataset 2. You may use the formula from the lesson, the skewness formula in excel (=SKEW) or you can plot it on a graph

Solution:

Dataset 1
212
869
220
654
511
624
420
121
428
865
799
405
230
670
870
366
99
55
489
312
493
163
221
84
144
48
375
86
168
100

Task 1:

Skewness 0.63

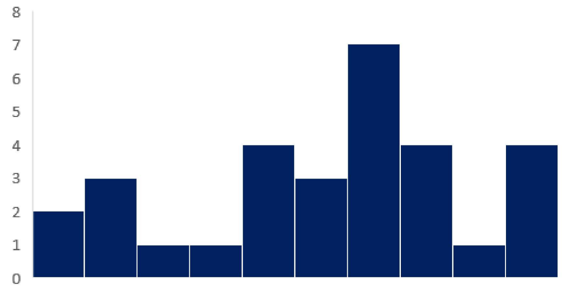


The skew of this dataset is positive.

Dataset 2
586
760
495
678
559
415
370
659
119
288
241
787
522
207
160
526
656
848
720
676
581
929
653
661
770
800
529
975
995
947

Task 2:

Skewness -0.37



The skew of this dataset is negative.

Note: sometimes, using a graph to identify the skew can be misleading.

This dataset has a relatively strong negative skew (-0.37).

However, from a histogram with a few bins, you cannot clearly determine the skew.

For best results, we recommend that you use a more precise measure of skewness, such as the formula, instead of a simple graph